

Chapter 3, Section 6

James Lee

October 6, 2026

1. Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space, and let $\mathcal{F}', \mathcal{F}'' \in \mathfrak{Mod}(X)$. An *extension* of $\mathcal{F}''$ by $\mathcal{F}'$ is a short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}'' \longrightarrow 0$$

in $\mathfrak{Mod}(X)$. Two extensions are *isomorphic* if there is an isomorphism of the short exact sequences, inducing the identity maps on $\mathcal{F}'$ and $\mathcal{F}''$. Given an extension as above consider the long exact sequence arising from $\text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \cdot)$, in particular the map

$$\delta : \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}'') \rightarrow \text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}'),$$

and let $\xi \in \text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}')$ by $\delta(1_{\mathcal{F}''})$. Show that this process gives a one-to-one correspondence between isomorphism classes of extensions of $\mathcal{F}''$ by $\mathcal{F}'$, and elements of the group $\text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}')$.

Proof. Let $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{F}' \rightarrow \mathcal{I}^\bullet$ be an injective resolution of $\mathcal{F}'$. An element of the group $\xi \in \text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}')$ gives a morphism $\xi : \mathcal{F}'' \rightarrow \mathcal{I}^1$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{F}'' & & \\ \xi \downarrow & \searrow 0 & \\ \mathcal{I}^1 & \xrightarrow{\psi} & \mathcal{I}^2 \end{array}$$

commutes, i.e., $\xi \in \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{I}^0/\mathcal{F}')$. From now, denote this subsheaf of $\mathcal{I}^1$ as $\mathcal{J} = \mathcal{I}^0/\mathcal{F}'$. The pull-back diagram of ξ and ψ gives the following commutative diagram with exact rows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}' & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{I}^0 \times_{\mathcal{I}^1} \mathcal{F}'' & \dashrightarrow & \mathcal{F}'' \longrightarrow 0 \\ & & \parallel & & \downarrow & & \xi \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}' & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{I}^0 & \xrightarrow{\psi} & \mathcal{J} \longrightarrow 0 \end{array},$$

so the top row is an extension of $\mathcal{F}''$ by $\mathcal{F}'$. If we are given another representative $\bar{\xi}$ of ξ , then $\bar{\xi} - \xi = j \circ \psi$ for some $\psi \in \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{I}^0)$, and repeating the construction above for $j \circ \psi$ gives the trivial extension $\mathcal{F}' \times \mathcal{F}''$ of $\mathcal{F}''$ by $\mathcal{F}'$, so this construction is well-defined. Because $\text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \cdot)$ is a covariant δ -functor, there is a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}'') & \xrightarrow{\delta} & \text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}') \\ \downarrow & & \parallel \\ \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{J}) & \longrightarrow & \text{Ext}^1(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}') \end{array}$$

which ensures $\delta(1_{\mathcal{F}''}) = \xi$. Hence, this process is surjective.

To prove injectivity, we show $\mathcal{F} \cong \mathcal{I}^0 \times_{\mathcal{I}^1} \mathcal{F}''$. Let $\alpha : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}''$ be the epimorphism from the extension. By injectivity of $\mathcal{I}^0$, there exists a morphism $\beta : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{I}^0$ that extends $\mathcal{F}' \rightarrow \mathcal{I}^0$, which induces a morphism $\gamma : \mathcal{F}'' \rightarrow \mathcal{I}^1$ making the following diagram commute

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}' & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}'' \longrightarrow 0 \\ & & \parallel & & \beta \downarrow & & \gamma \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}' & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{I}^0 & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{J} \longrightarrow 0 \end{array}.$$

The pull-back $\mathcal{I}^0 \times_{\mathcal{I}^1} \mathcal{F}''$ is unique up to unique isomorphism, so it remains to show γ is a representative of ξ . Again, $\text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \cdot)$ is a covariant δ -functor with $\text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{F}'') \rightarrow \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}'', \mathcal{J})$ given by composition with γ , so γ is a representative of ξ . □

3. Let X be a Noetherian scheme, and let $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G} \in \mathfrak{Mod}(X)$.

- (a) If $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$ are both coherent, then $\mathcal{E}xt^i(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$ is coherent, for all $i \geq 0$.
- (b) If $\mathcal{F}$ is coherent and $\mathcal{G}$ is quasi-coherent, then $\mathcal{E}xt^i(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$ is quasi-coherent, for all $i \geq 0$.

Proof.

- (a) The question is local (6.2), so assume $X = \text{Spec } A$ for some Noetherian ring A , and $\mathcal{F} \cong \tilde{M}, \mathcal{G} \cong \tilde{N}$ for some A -modules M, N . Because A is Noetherian, there exists a finite free resolution of M

$$F_\bullet \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0$$

where each $F_\bullet$ is a free A -module of finite rank. Applying the $\sim$ -functor and setting $\mathcal{L}_\bullet = \tilde{F}_\bullet$, we obtain a free resolution of $\mathcal{F}$ of finite rank

$$\mathcal{L}_\bullet \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow 0,$$

which we can use to compute $\mathcal{E}xt^i(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$ (6.5)

$$\mathcal{E}xt^i(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}) \cong h^i(\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{L}_\bullet, \mathcal{G})).$$

By equivalence of categories between coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules and finitely generated A -modules (§2, 5.5), one has

$$\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{L}_\bullet, \mathcal{G}) \cong \widetilde{\text{Hom}_A(F_\bullet, N)}.$$

Each $\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{L}_\bullet, \mathcal{G})$ is coherent because each $\text{Hom}(F_\bullet, N)$ is finitely generated, and A is Noetherian, so any sub- $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module of $\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{L}_\bullet, \mathcal{G})$ is also coherent (§2, 5.7). Hence, $\mathcal{E}xt^i(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$ is coherent for every $i \geq 0$.

- (b) The proof is essentially the same as (a) except $\mathcal{G} \cong \tilde{N}$ for some A -module N , and the result still follows by (§2, 5.7). □

6. Let A be a regular local ring, and let M be a finitely generated A -module. In this case, strengthen the result (6.10A) as follows.

- (a) M is projective if and only if $\text{Ext}^i(M, A) = 0$ for all $i > 0$.
- (b) Use (a) to show that for any n , $\text{pd } M \leq n$ if and only if $\text{Ext}^i(M, A) = 0$ for all $i > n$.

Proof.

- (a) Noetherian local rings have finite Krull dimension, so $n = \text{pd}(M) < \infty$ (6.11A), and $\text{Ext}_A^i(M, N) = 0$ for all $i > n$ and all A -modules N (6.10A). Suppose $\text{Ext}_A^i(M, A) = 0$ for all $i > 0$. Let N be any finitely generated A -module. There exists an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow K \longrightarrow A^{\oplus m} \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow 0,$$

where K is some finitely generated A -module. Applying $\text{Hom}_A(M, \cdot)$ gives a long exact sequence in cohomology

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &\longrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(M, K) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(M, A^{\oplus m}) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(M, N) \longrightarrow \\ &\longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^1(M, K) \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^1(M, A^{\oplus m}) \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^1(M, N) \longrightarrow \cdots \\ &\cdots \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^n(M, K) \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^n(M, A^{\oplus m}) \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^n(M, N) \longrightarrow 0. \end{aligned}$$

The $\text{Hom}_A(M, \cdot)$ functor commute with direct sums, so $\text{Ext}_A^i(M, A^{\oplus m}) \cong \text{Ext}_A^i(M, A)^{\oplus m} = 0$ for all $i > 0$. By the long exact sequence of above, $\text{Ext}_A^{i-1}(M, N) \cong \text{Ext}_A^i(M, K)$ and $\text{Ext}_A^n(M, N) = 0$. Thus, $\text{Ext}_A^n(M, N) = 0$ for all finitely generated A -modules N , and descending induction on i shows $\text{Ext}_A^i(M, N) = 0$ for all $i > 0$ and all finitely generated A -modules N .

By assumption, M is finitely generated, so there exists an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow Q \longrightarrow A^{\oplus r} \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0$$

where Q is a finitely generated A -module. Since $\text{Ext}_A^1(M, Q) = 0$, which classifies all extensions of M by Q , $A^{\oplus r}$ must be the trivial extension of M by Q , i.e., $A^{\oplus r} \cong M \oplus Q$.

Let $\pi : N' \rightarrow N$ be a surjective A -module homomorphism and $\phi : M \rightarrow N$ any A -module homomorphism. There is a natural extension of ϕ to $A^{\oplus r}$ via taking the pull-back by the projection $A^{\oplus r} \rightarrow M$. Any free module is projective, so there exists unique A -module homomorphism $h : A^{\oplus r} \rightarrow N'$ such that $\phi' = \pi \circ h$, so by restriction one has $\phi = \pi \circ h|_M$. Hence, M is projective. In particular, a module is projective if and only if it is a direct summand of a free module.

(b) We prove the following general result from (Weibel, 1994):

Lemma 0.1. *Let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ be a left exact contravariant functor between two Abelian categories. Assume $\mathcal{A}$ has enough projectives. If*

$$0 \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow P_m \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow P_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0$$

is an exact sequence in $\mathcal{C}$ with the P_i projective (or F -cyclic), then $R^i F(M) \cong R^{i-m-1} F(N)$ for $i \geq m+2$.

For each $0 \leq j \leq m+1$, label the morphisms $f_j : P_j \rightarrow P_{j-1}$, where P_{-1}, P_{m+1} understood as M, N , respectively. We have an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{im } f_{j+1} \longrightarrow P_j \longrightarrow \text{im } f_j \longrightarrow 0,$$

which induces the natural isomorphism

$$R^i F(\text{im } f_j) \cong R^{i-1} F(\text{im } f_{j+1})$$

for all $i \geq 2$. Thus,

$$R^i F(\text{im } f_j) \cong R^{i-k} F(\text{im } f_{j+k})$$

for all $i \geq k+1$. Since $\text{im } f_0 = M$ and $\text{im } f_{m+1} = N$, setting $j = 0$ and $k = m+1$, we obtain our desired result.

Continuing on to our main problem, let M be a finitely generated A -module, and suppose $\text{Ext}_A^i(M, A) = 0$ for all $i > n$. Let $P_\bullet \rightarrow M \rightarrow 0$ be any projective resolution of M , and consider the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow N \longrightarrow P_{n-1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow P_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0$$

where N is the image of $P_{n+1} \rightarrow P_n$. Applying Lemma 1 with $F = \text{Hom}(\cdot, A)$ and $i = n+1$ so that $R^i F = \text{Ext}_A^i(\cdot, A)$, one has an isomorphism

$$\text{Ext}_A^{n+1}(M, A) \cong \text{Ext}_A^1(N, A).$$

But $\text{Ext}_A^{n+1}(M, A) = 0$, so N is projective by (a). Hence, $\text{pd } M \leq n$.

□

7. Let $X = \text{Spec } A$ be an affine Noetherian scheme. Let M, N be A -modules, with M finitely generated. Then

$$\text{Ext}_X^i(\tilde{M}, \tilde{N}) \cong \text{Ext}_A^i(M, N)$$

and

$$\mathcal{E}xt_X^i(\tilde{M}, \tilde{N}) \cong \widetilde{\text{Ext}_A^i(M, N)}.$$

Proof. Both sides are δ -functors in N from $\mathfrak{Mod}(A)$ to $\mathfrak{Ab}$, and the functors $\mathrm{Hom}_X(\tilde{M}, \cdot)$ and $\mathrm{Hom}_A(M, \cdot)$ are equal (§2, 5.5), so their derived functors (as functors from $\mathfrak{Mod}(A)$ to $\mathfrak{Ab}$) are the same.

For the next isomorphism, both sides are δ -functors in N from $\mathfrak{Mod}(A)$ to $\mathfrak{Mod}(X)$ because the $\sim$ -functor is an exact functor. Both sides vanish for $i > 0$ and N injective A -module because localization is exact, and $\tilde{N}$ is flasque if N is injective (3.4). Thus, to invoke (1.3A), we need to show the functors are equal for $i = 0$. We check locally. If $x \in X$ is a point, let $\mathfrak{p}$ be the prime ideal in A corresponding to x . By (§2, 5.1) and (6.8), we have

$$\mathcal{E}xt_X^i(\tilde{M}, \tilde{N})_x \cong \mathrm{Ext}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}^i(M_{\mathfrak{p}}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}), \quad \widetilde{\mathrm{Ext}_A^i(M, N)}_x \cong \mathrm{Ext}^i(M, N)_{\mathfrak{p}},$$

and there is a natural map of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules

$$\begin{aligned} \widetilde{\mathrm{Hom}_A(M, N)} &\rightarrow \mathcal{H}om_X(\tilde{M}, \tilde{N}) \\ f/s &\mapsto (m \mapsto f(m)/s). \end{aligned}$$

Thus, we reduce to the following algebraic problem: let A be a Noetherian ring, M, N A -modules with M finitely generated. Then the natural map of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ -modules

$$\mathrm{Hom}_A(M, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(M_{\mathfrak{p}}, N_{\mathfrak{p}})$$

is an isomorphism. If M is finitely generated, there exists an exact sequence

$$A^{\oplus n} \longrightarrow A^{\oplus r} \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0.$$

Applying $\mathrm{Hom}_A(\cdot, N)$ and localizing the first exact sequence gives

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_A(M, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_A(A^{\oplus r}, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_A(A^{\oplus n}, N)_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

Switching the order, i.e., localizing first then applying $\mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(\cdot, N_{\mathfrak{p}})$, gives

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(M_{\mathfrak{p}}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(A_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\oplus r}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(A_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\oplus n}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}).$$

The statement obvious holds For finite free modules

$$\mathrm{Hom}_A(A^{\oplus r}, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} \cong N_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\oplus r} \cong \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(A_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\oplus r}, N_{\mathfrak{p}})$$

We obtain our desired isomorphism by applying the five lemma to the following commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_A(M, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_A(A^{\oplus r}, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_A(A^{\oplus n}, N)_{\mathfrak{p}} \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(M_{\mathfrak{p}}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(A_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\oplus r}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(A_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\oplus n}, N_{\mathfrak{p}}) \end{array}.$$

□

8. Prove the following theorem of Kleiman: if X is a Noetherian, integral, separated, locally factorial scheme, then every coherent sheaf on X is a quotient of a locally free sheaf (of finite rank).

- (a) First show that open sets of the form X_s , for various $s \in \Gamma(X, \mathcal{L})$, and various invertible sheaves $\mathcal{L}$ on X , form a base for the topology of X .
- (b) Now use (II, 5.14) to show that any coherent sheaf is a quotient of a direct sum $\bigoplus \mathcal{L}_i^{n_i}$ for various invertible sheaves $\mathcal{L}_i$ and various integers n_i .

10. *Duality for a Finite Flat Morphism.*

- (a) Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a finite morphism of Noetherian schemes. For any quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module $\mathcal{G}$, $\mathcal{H}om_Y(f_*\mathcal{O}_X, \mathcal{G})$ is a quasi-coherent $f_*\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, hence corresponds to a quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, which we call $f^!\mathcal{G}$ (II, Ex. 5.17e).

(b) Show that for any coherent $\mathcal{F}$ on X and any quasi-coherent $\mathcal{G}$ on Y , there is a natural isomorphism

$$f_* \mathcal{H}om_X(\mathcal{F}, f^! \mathcal{G}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{H}om_Y(f_* \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}).$$

(c) For each $i \geq 0$, there is a natural map

$$\varphi_i : \mathrm{Ext}_X^i(\mathcal{F}, f^! \mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Ext}_Y^i(f_* \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}).$$

(d) Now assume that X and Y are separated, $\mathfrak{Coh}(X)$ has enough locally free, and assume that $f_* \mathcal{O}_X$ is locally free on Y (this is equivalent to saying f flat - see §9). Show that φ_i is an isomorphism for all i , all $\mathcal{F}$ coherent on X , and all $\mathcal{G}$ quasi-coherent on Y .

Proof.

(b) The question is local on Y , so we can assume $Y = \mathrm{Spec} A$ for some Noetherian ring A . Then $X = \mathrm{Spec} B$ for some finite A -algebra B so that

$$f_* \mathcal{O}_X \cong \tilde{B}, \quad \mathcal{F} \cong \tilde{M}, \quad \mathcal{G} \cong \tilde{N}$$

for some finitely generated B -module M , and A -module N . Now, the statement just says there is a natural isomorphism of A -modules

$$\mathrm{Hom}_B(M, \mathrm{Hom}_A(B, N)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Hom}_A(M, N).$$

(c) If $\mathcal{H}$ is any quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, there is a natural map

$$\mathrm{Hom}_X(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{H}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_Y(f_* \mathcal{F}, f_* \mathcal{H})$$

by functoriality of f_* . Note that f_* is an exact functor when f is a finite morphism (8.1), so both $\mathrm{Ext}_X^i(\mathcal{F}, \cdot)$ and $\mathrm{Ext}_Y^i(f_* \mathcal{F}, f_* \cdot)$ is a δ -functor in $\mathcal{H}$ from $\mathfrak{Mod}(X)$ to $\mathfrak{Ab}$. Since $\mathrm{Ext}_X^i(\mathcal{F}, \cdot)$ is a universal δ -functor (1.4), there is an induced natural map by definition

$$\psi_i : \mathrm{Ext}_X^i(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{H}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Ext}_Y^i(f_* \mathcal{F}, f_* \mathcal{H}).$$

Now, consider the case $\mathcal{H} = f^! \mathcal{G}$. Taking the global sections of (b) shows

$$\mathrm{Hom}_X(f^! \mathcal{G}, f^! \mathcal{G}) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_Y(f_* f^! \mathcal{G}, \mathcal{G}),$$

so let $\xi : f_* f^! \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ be the morphism corresponding to the identity $1_{f^! \mathcal{G}}$. Then ξ induces a map of derived functors

$$\xi_i : \mathrm{Ext}_Y^i(f_* \mathcal{F}, f_* f^! \mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Ext}_Y^i(f_* \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}).$$

Hence, $\varphi_i = \xi_i \circ \psi_i$ is our desired natural map.

□